

PM Planning with Adam (12/16/2025)

News for Today

- Average Hourly Earnings (MoM) (Oct) Actual (0.4%) Previous (0.2%) (8:30AM)
- Average Hourly Earnings (MoM) (Nov) Actual (Actual) (0.1%) Forecast (0.3%) Previous (0.4%) (8:30AM)
- Nonfarm Payrolls (Oct) Actual (-105K) Previous (108K) (8:30AM)
- Core Retail Sales (MoM) (Oct) Actual (0.4%) Forecast (0.2%) Previous (0.1%) (8:30AM)
- Retail Sales (MoM) (Oct) Actual (0.0%) Forecast (0.1%) Previous (0.1%) (8:30AM)
- Unemployment Rate (Nov) Actual (4.6%) Forecast (4.5%) Previous (4.4%) (8:30AM)
- S&P Global Services PMI (Dec) Forecast (54.0) Previous (54.1) (9:45AM)
- Ford (\$F) +1.4% — Shares rose after the automaker announced a \$19.5B writedown and confirmed it is canceling several EV models, signaling a strategic pullback from unprofitable electric vehicle investments.
- Pfizer (\$PFE) +0.8% — The drugmaker gained despite forecasting 2026 profit below expectations, as investors looked past declining COVID product sales and focused on pipeline stabilization.
- Kraft Heinz (\$KHC) +0.7% — The stock moved higher after naming industry veteran Steve Cahillane as CEO, ahead of its planned split into two independent public companies.
- Circle Internet (\$CRCL) +3.5% — Shares climbed after Visa announced USDC settlement support in the U.S., a major milestone for stablecoin adoption in traditional finance.

- iRobot (\$IRBT) -20% — The stock extended losses following last session's collapse after the Roomba maker filed for bankruptcy, deepening concerns over its survival.
 - Accenture (\$ACN) +2.1% — Shares rose after Morgan Stanley upgraded the stock to "overweight", citing an attractive valuation after this year's pullback.
 - Cognex (\$CGNX) +4.3% — The software company jumped after Goldman Sachs upgraded it to "buy", pointing to an inflection in organic growth and improving margins.
 - Southwest Airlines (\$LUV) +2.1% — The airline gained after Barclays upgraded the stock to "overweight", highlighting optimism around its revamped commercial strategy, including assigned seating and baggage fees.
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Market Overview — Tuesday, December 16, 2025

Futures Slip as Key Data Looms, AI Worries Linger

U.S. stock futures traded lower to start the week, extending recent weakness as investors turned cautious ahead of a heavy slate of U.S. economic data — especially a delayed labor market report following the prolonged government shutdown.

- Dow Futures fell 185 points (-0.4%)
- S&P 500 Futures dropped 47 points (-0.7%)
- Nasdaq 100 Futures slid 261 points (-1.0%)

The main averages closed sharply lower in the prior session, marking their worst daily declines in more than three weeks. While stocks attempted an intraday rebound, momentum faded amid renewed doubts over AI-related capital spending, following underwhelming earnings from Oracle and Broadcom.

Adding to the caution, traders also weighed reports that Kevin Hassett's potential nomination as Fed Chair is facing internal resistance within the Trump administration, raising uncertainty around the future direction of U.S. monetary policy.

All Eyes on Delayed Jobs Data

Investor focus now shifts firmly toward a packed economic calendar, with data likely to shape expectations for interest rates heading into the new year.

- Nonfarm payrolls for November are expected to show a muted gain of ~35,000 jobs, according to Reuters
- October payrolls, which were never released due to the shutdown, will be rolled into this report
- A new unemployment rate will also be released — creating a historic gap in the data series

Additional reports this week include retail sales, a flash business activity survey, and November CPI, all of which could influence the Fed's next policy steps after last week's 25 bp rate cut.

With policymakers previously lacking access to fresh data during the shutdown, this week's releases may carry outsized influence on future rate decisions.

Nasdaq Eyes Longer Trading Hours

Nasdaq is reportedly seeking regulatory approval to extend trading hours to nearly 23 hours a day, according to Bloomberg.

- Proposed new session: 9:00 PM – 4:00 AM ET
- Would complement existing pre-market, regular, and after-hours trading
- Aims to meet rising global demand for U.S. equities

Nasdaq officials have indicated discussions with regulators are already underway, with potential implementation targeted for the second half of 2026.

Lennar Earnings in Focus

Earnings are otherwise light, but homebuilder Lennar is set to report after the close.

- Wall Street expects EPS of \$2.24 on \$9.1B in revenue
- Net new orders forecast at 20,288
- Sentiment remains cautious as housing demand stays pressured

Despite rate cuts, elevated bond yields continue to weigh on mortgage affordability, forcing builders to rely on incentives and price adjustments, which in turn threaten margins.

Oil Slides on Peace Deal Hopes

Oil prices moved sharply lower as rising optimism around Russia-Ukraine peace talks fueled expectations of easing sanctions and increased supply.

- Brent crude fell 1.2% to \$59.82
- WTI crude dropped 1.3% to \$55.95

Any progress toward a negotiated settlement could pave the way for Russian oil exports to return more freely, adding pressure to an already well-supplied global market.

Adam's Watchlist

- \$QQQ: Looking to go long off the 611.78's KL for a push up into the 615.13's KL and potentially the 618.44's KL. If we break below, I'll be looking to go short off the 607's KL for a push down into the 603.90's KL and potentially the 600's KL.
- \$F: Looking to go long off the 14's KL for a push up into the 14.86's KL.
- \$PFE: Looking to go long off the 27's KL for a BSL Swing.

- \$CRCL: Looking to go long off the 78's KL for a push up into the 79.80's KL and potentially the 82's KL.
 - \$LUV: Looking to go long off the 42.20's KL for an ATH breakout.
 - \$UPS: Looking to go long off the 100's KL for a push up into the 102's KL and potentially the 103's KL.
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